

Quick Check

Lesson 5: Scientific Names and Binomial Nomenclature: One Name for Every Organism

7 multiple-choice questions • choose A, B, C or D

Sub-Strand 1.1: Taxonomy I | Lesson 5

A farmer in Kisumu and a researcher in Nairobi each use only their own local name for a mosquito species when sharing information about malaria control. What problem is most likely to happen?

- A** Local names are always wrong, so neither person can describe the mosquito
- B** The mosquito will change its behaviour depending on the name used
- C** They may not be sure they are talking about the same organism, so mistakes can happen
- D** The mosquito can only be studied by people who speak Kiswahili

In some countries the word 'corn' means maize, but in other countries it means a different cereal. What does this show about common names?

- A** A common name always tells us exactly which species an organism is
- B** Common names are only used for plants, never for animals
- C** Common names are the same everywhere in the world
- D** The same common name can refer to different organisms, which causes confusion

You want to handwrite the scientific name of the goat, *Capra hircus*, following the rules of binomial nomenclature. What should you do?

- A** Underline the genus and the species separately
- B** Write the whole name in capital letters instead of underlining
- C** Underline the whole name with one continuous line so the two words are joined
- D** Write the name in brackets so that it can be told apart from other words

A learner writes the scientific name of the mosquito as *Anopheles Gambiae*. Which rule of binomial nomenclature has been broken?

A The species name must start with a small letter

B The genus must start with a small letter

C A scientific name must be written in Kiswahili

D A scientific name must have three parts

A group writes the claim: 'Scientists need a scientific name for each organism even though people already have common names.' Which reasoning best supports this claim?

- A** Scientific names are longer than common names, so they are more useful
- B** Scientific names are in Latin, and Latin is the easiest language for everyone to speak
- C** Local names are wrong and should not be used by anyone
- D** Each organism has one accepted two-part name used worldwide, so scientists everywhere know which organism is meant and can share information without confusion

In a class debate, a learner says: 'Now that we have scientific names, we should stop using local names like mbuzi, mbũri and diel.' Which response is best?

- A** Disagree, because local names remain valuable in communities, while scientific names are used for communication among scientists worldwide
- B** Agree, because scientific names replace local names completely
- C** Disagree, because scientific names can only be used for plants
- D** Agree, because local names are never correct

Learners add a Naming Layer to the class model and label the scientific name of the goat, *Capra hircus*. Which labelling is correct?

A Genus: *Capra hircus*; Species: goat

B Genus: mbuzi; Species: *Capra hircus*

C Genus: hircus; Species: *Capra*

D Genus: *Capra*; Species: hircus

All done

Ask your teacher how to submit your answers today (for example, on a paper answer slip).